

increasing variations of free offline office suites are becoming available. Free from the dependence on the internet for conducting your work, these packages allow you to make the most of office suite applications without having to shell out a single penny.

Apache OpenOffice

The Apache OpenOffice suite is one of the widest and most popular open source office productivity suites currently available. The application package comes bundled with a host of software that cover all the necessary requirements including word processing, spreadsheet making, presentation making, and database and graphic management along with many other useful features.

The Apache suite is part of the open source movement and is free to use across the world. Its development and service is done through communities of open source developers who consistently provide upgrades and patches that improves the functionality and features of all the prod-



Arguably one of the best free ones out there

ucts included. Due to the vast reach of the open source community, the software is easily available in an assortment of international languages and oriented to work across nearly all hardware and operating system platforms.

The file storage format of the OpenOffice system is known as the international open standard format and is compatible across most other file formats that are in use. This means that any file made using OpenOffice can be worked on using other office suite software. Apache OpenOffice is available for free online as a downloadable file and isn't sold anywhere else.

History and development

The Apache OpenOffice system is one of the biggest examples of the success of open source programming in the world. The development of the application package began in 1985 when it was called 'StarOffice'. The